

‘MY BASEBALL DAD’

Reunited at the big-league level last year, Chicago native and Cubs assistant hitting coach John Mallee has been a constant in Pete Crow-Armstrong’s quest to reach MVP caliber



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Trump threatens to ‘annihilate’ Iran

TWO GOP CANDIDATES WANT END OF WAR:

Two Republicans in tight Senate races have called for an end to the war in Iran, the latest sign that some candidates feel compelled to distance themselves from President Donald Trump as they face voters angry about surging prices tied to the conflict. **Nation & World, Page B5**

Tehran delegation walks out of address to UN as president offers ultimatum on peace talks

By Aamer Madhani, Farnoush Amiri and Edith M. Lederer
ASSOCIATED PRESS

UNITED NATIONS — President Donald Trump said U.S. and Iranian officials met Tuesday, shortly after threatening in his address to the

U.N. General Assembly that he may “annihilate” the Islamic Republic if a deal isn’t reached soon to end the nearly seven-month war.

Trump told reporters that his chief envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, met with the Iranian officials on the sidelines of the annual gathering of world lead-

ers, but he offered few details about how the discussions transpired or the substance of the exchange.

“It was a very good meeting,” Trump said.

The president later added that the Iranian officials were “not the highest level, but it’s something.”

The engagement comes after months of U.S.-Iran communications languishing following the collapse of a short-lived ceasefire that was brokered June 17.

U.S. and Iranian negotiators met separately with Qatari and Pakistani mediators in Doha in early July for indirect talks.

Separately, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Tuesday that Trump is open to meeting with Iran’s president, Masoud Pezeshkian, while both are in New York for the General Assembly.

“This is a president that will meet

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A swell relationship

Isaac Jamerson and girlfriend Lauren Herron celebrate their one-year anniversary on the choppy lakefront near Chicago’s Oak Street Beach on Tuesday. The National Weather Service warned of Lake Michigan beach hazards through Wednesday evening.

ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Art Institute to return painting looted by Nazis

Breakthrough on faint handwriting helps get ‘Woman with a Fan’ in hands of Jewish heirs

By Nina Metz
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For the past 30 years, descendants of Jewish art collectors whose works were looted by the Nazis during World War II have

sought to reclaim stolen works of art.

On Tuesday, the Art Institute of Chicago announced it is returning a 1913 painting, “Woman with a Fan” by Jean Metzinger, to the heirs of its original owner.

“What is significant here is our research confirms the painting was owned by the Lewenstein family, a Jewish family who lived in Amsterdam, and that the painting was sold in a forced sale in 1940 in Nazi-occupied Amsterdam,” said Jacques Schuhmacher, executive director of provenance research at the museum.

The Art Institute conducted

its research in collaboration with the Mondex Corp., a Canadian company founded in 1993 that specializes in the recovery of artworks and cultural artifacts. Mondex represents the heirs in this case.

According to information on the Mondex website, the Jewish art

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ELECTION 2027 MAYOR

Quinlan sues over foes’ dual pursuits

Giannoulas, Pappas, Quigley all seeking wins in other races

By Alice Yin and Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As Illinois Secretary of State Alexi Giannoulas launched his campaign to run for Chicago mayor in 2027, he left one important detail unsaid: He’s also running for reelection in this November’s election.

The first-term secretary of state and mayoral candidate nonetheless responded with a succinct “No” when a reporter inquired after last month’s announcement whether it was hypocritical to ask millions of Illinois voters to return him to his statewide office while he also campaigned to lead the nation’s third-largest city. It’s a dynamic facing a North Side congressman running to unseat Mayor Brandon Johnson in the February 2027 race, as well as a Cook County elected official considering a mayoral run — and a situation that has emerged many times before in Illinois where insider Democratic politics rules the land.

But this year could be different as some critics are taking the opportunity to attack politicians for trying to have it both ways. On Tuesday, mayoral candidate and lawyer William J. Quinlan sued Giannoulas, U.S. Rep. Mike Quigley and Cook County Treasurer Maria Pappas, all Democrats, for being on the ballot this November for another term in their current seats while also launching, or

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‘That was God opening up a door’

To fill chronic shortage of paraprofessionals, nonprofit turns to parents already in building

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For years, Maria Johnson slipped into Chicago Public Schools classrooms as a volunteer parent, an extra set of hands to help students sound out their reading. She can’t recall exactly when she started: Her eldest son is now 22.

“I was not only trying to be there for my son, but I wanted to be there for other children, because I know everybody doesn’t get that,” John-

son said.

She had no intention of stopping. Then, last fall, a nonprofit offered to help turn that commitment into a career — with free classes and one-on-one coaching toward a license as a paid paraprofessional. Seven months later, she was hired as a special education classroom assistant, or a SECA, at Benjamin E. Mays Academy in Englewood.

Johnson, 53, already held a college degree, but hadn’t been a student herself for more than

three decades. “I just felt like that was God opening up a door for me to have a career,” she said.

Ladders of Opportunity is a relatively new statewide nonprofit working to address Illinois’ chronic shortage of paraprofessionals. It grew out of the Parent Engagement Institute, which recruits parents to volunteer in their children’s schools. Ladders takes it a step further, moving parents with at least 100 volunteer hours and an interest in an education career into its licensure track.

Most of them are Black and

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Maria Johnson arrives at her job as a special education classroom assistant at Benjamin E. Mays Academy in Chicago on Sept. 15.

ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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